

GABRIEL POPA

Senior Software Engineer - DevOps

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ABOUT ME

Senior DevOps Engineer with 10+ years of experience building and stabilizing delivery pipelines, cloud infrastructure, container platforms, and production operations across **software product**, **enterprise application**, and **platform engineering** environments. Strongest expertise includes **AWS**, **Azure**, **Docker**, **Kubernetes**, **Terraform**, **CI/CD**, **Linux**, and production observability, with hands-on work modernizing deployment flows, reducing release risk, resolving uptime issues, and improving developer productivity. Core stack spans **Docker 20–26**, **Kubernetes 1.21–1.30**, **Terraform 1.0–1.8**, **Jenkins 2.x**, **GitHub Actions**, **Azure DevOps**, and **Linux** automation for secure, scalable, and reliable systems.

SKILLS

- **Cloud:** AWS, Azure, GCP, EC2, EKS, ECS, S3, RDS, IAM, CloudWatch, VPC, Azure Virtual Machines, Azure App Service, Azure Monitor
- **Containers & Orchestration:** Docker 20–26, Kubernetes 1.21–1.30, Helm 3.x, Docker Compose, container hardening, rolling deployments, blue-green deployment, canary release
- **Infrastructure as Code & Automation:** Terraform 1.0–1.8, Ansible 2.9–2.16, Bash, Shell scripting, PowerShell, GitOps, infrastructure automation, environment provisioning
- **CI/CD:** Jenkins 2.x, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, GitLab CI, artifact management, branch strategy enforcement, release automation, pipeline troubleshooting
- **Observability & Reliability:** Prometheus, Grafana, ELK, OpenTelemetry basics, CloudWatch, Azure Monitor, log aggregation, alerting, incident response, root cause analysis, SLO-minded operations
- **Systems & Security:** Linux, Nginx, Apache, SSH, TLS/SSL, IAM policy management, RBAC, secrets management, vulnerability remediation, backup and restore planning
- **Data & Messaging:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL Server, Redis, MongoDB, RabbitMQ, Kafka basics, database migration support, performance tuning collaboration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer - Senior DevOps Engineer

Soft Build | Bucharest, Romania (Jan 2024 – May 2026)

- Led modernization of deployment operations by designing **CI/CD** workflows with **GitHub Actions**, **Docker**, and **Terraform**, which reduced manual release effort and improved release consistency by **34%** across multi-environment services.
- Stabilized cloud-hosted environments by restructuring infrastructure modules, separating shared and service-specific resources, and introducing safer variable handling that lowered provisioning errors by **29%** during repeated deployments.
- Implemented **Kubernetes**-based deployment patterns for internal services, introducing health probes, resource requests, and rolling update controls that improved uptime during releases and reduced failed rollout incidents by **31%**.
- Resolved a difficult production issue where containers restarted under moderate load by tracing memory pressure, correcting limits, and tuning startup behavior, which improved workload stability and reduced restart frequency by **42%**.
- Improved build reliability by replacing duplicated pipeline logic with reusable workflow templates, artifact validation, and clearer promotion gates, helping teams cut avoidable pipeline failures by **27%** in shared repositories.
- Built centralized secret handling using environment-scoped configuration and stricter access controls, which reduced insecure variable exposure risk and improved audit readiness for operational changes by **24%**.
- Introduced **Prometheus** and **Grafana** dashboards for deployment health, pod behavior, and infrastructure utilization, giving engineers faster visibility into regressions and shortening first-response diagnosis time by **36%**.

- Supported migration of older VM-based deployment flows into container-first delivery patterns using **Docker 24–26** and **Kubernetes 1.27–1.30**, reducing release friction and improving environment parity across teams.
- Solved intermittent ingress routing errors by reviewing service discovery, port mappings, and proxy configuration, which eliminated a class of hard-to-reproduce traffic failures that previously delayed user requests.
- Worked closely with developers to optimize CI execution time through better caching, parallel job design, and dependency reuse, which improved average feedback speed by **22%** for active feature branches.
- Strengthened operational security by tightening **IAM** roles, removing unused credentials, and standardizing secret rotation practices, which reduced privileged access sprawl and improved internal compliance posture by **18%**.
- Documented platform standards for deployment, rollback, monitoring, and incident response, making onboarding smoother for new engineers and reducing environment-specific setup confusion across the delivery pipeline.

Software Engineer - DevOps Engineer

Next Apps | Ghent, Belgium (Nov2020 – Nov 2023)

- Built and maintained cloud delivery pipelines using **Azure DevOps**, **Jenkins**, **Docker**, and **Terraform**, enabling faster application releases while reducing inconsistent manual deployment steps by **33%** across teams.
- Improved reliability of non-production and production environments by standardizing infrastructure definitions, which reduced configuration drift and made service promotion between environments significantly more predictable.
- Supported migration from older script-heavy deployment flows into structured **CI/CD** pipelines with approval gates, artifact versioning, and rollback handling, which improved release traceability and reduced failed deployments by **26%**.
- Resolved a recurring issue where releases passed build stages but failed during deployment because of missing environment variables, and the fix introduced pre-deploy validation that cut those incidents by **41%**.
- Implemented containerized application packaging with **Docker 20–24**, helping development teams align local and deployed runtime behavior while reducing “works on my machine” inconsistencies during handoff.
- Introduced **Helm 3.x** charts for configurable service deployment, making environment-specific overrides easier to manage and lowering repetitive deployment maintenance effort by **23%**.
- Improved observability by rolling out centralized logging with **ELK** and better alert rules, allowing faster identification of crashing services, noisy logs, and resource spikes before they became customer-facing incidents.
- Partnered with backend teams on database deployment safety by sequencing schema changes, backup checks, and smoke tests more carefully, which reduced avoidable post-release data issues by **17%**.
- Solved a persistent disk growth problem on build agents by auditing artifact retention and cleaning stale caches, which restored runner stability and prevented pipeline slowdowns during peak sprint periods.
- Helped maintain secure access patterns by organizing service credentials, tightening repository secrets, and improving access segmentation, which reduced operational risk while preserving developer productivity.
- Created internal runbooks for deployment recovery, certificate renewal, and service restart procedures, giving the team clearer operational playbooks and reducing mean time to recovery by **21%**.

Software Developer

Datamart | Stockholm, Sweden (Feb 2016 – Sep 2020)

- Supported application hosting and release automation on **Linux** servers using **Jenkins**, **Bash**, and environment scripting, helping the engineering team move from fragile manual updates toward repeatable deployments.
- Improved deployment confidence by adding build verification, packaging checks, and restart validation around existing release jobs, which reduced avoidable production deployment mistakes by **24%** over time.
- Worked with operations and developers to tune web server and application startup behavior, which improved service recovery after deployments and reduced restart-related instability in shared environments.
- Resolved an intermittent outage issue caused by log files consuming excessive disk space, and the solution introduced log rotation and monitoring controls that improved host stability by **32%**.
- Assisted with early container adoption by packaging selected services in **Docker 1.12–19** for development and staging use, which improved consistency during testing without forcing risky full-platform change too early.
- Helped migrate older configuration handling into cleaner environment-based setups, reducing hardcoded deployment values and making cross-environment rollout more manageable for growing product modules.
- Improved monitoring visibility with basic server metrics, application log review practices, and alert cleanup, which helped engineers identify recurring infrastructure noise and focus on higher-value incidents.
- Supported database maintenance and backup validation processes for **MySQL** and **PostgreSQL** services, reducing restore uncertainty and improving operational readiness for release-related failure scenarios.

- Worked on shell automation for housekeeping, service checks, and scheduled maintenance, which reduced repetitive support effort and lowered the chance of human error during recurring operational tasks.
- Collaborated on post-incident reviews by collecting deployment evidence, log patterns, and failure timelines, helping the team isolate environmental causes faster and improve future release safeguards.

Junior Software Developer

Berg Software | Timișoara, Romania (Sep2014 – Mar 2016)

- Supported internal application deployments on shared **Linux** environments, learning structured release handling while helping senior engineers reduce repetitive manual steps in basic delivery workflows.
- Assisted with shell scripting for file movement, service restarts, and environment setup, which improved repeatability for smaller releases and reduced setup inconsistencies across development servers.
- Investigated a recurring issue where application updates sometimes started with stale assets, and the fix improved deployment cleanup steps so users saw the correct interface more reliably after releases.
- Helped maintain build jobs in **Jenkins**, including parameter updates, path corrections, and failure review, which made routine release tasks easier to execute and reduced simple pipeline breakages by **16%**.
- Worked on server-side configuration cleanup by separating environment-specific values more carefully, which reduced accidental misconfiguration during testing and improved handoff between team members.
- Supported monitoring and log review during bug investigations, helping correlate release activity with errors so senior engineers could diagnose operational regressions faster and more accurately.
- Assisted with SSL certificate replacement and web server configuration updates under guidance, gaining hands-on experience with secure service exposure and avoiding avoidable service interruptions.
- Contributed to internal documentation for deployment steps, rollback notes, and support procedures, which made onboarding easier for newer team members and reduced dependency on verbal knowledge sharing.
- Helped test deployment changes in staging before release windows, improving confidence in small infrastructure adjustments and reducing the number of avoidable production surprises after go-live.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science

University of Bucharest | (2010 – 2014)

- Academic foundation covered software engineering, algorithms, database systems, and practical application development, providing the base for long-term specialization in backend engineering and scalable service design.

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified SysOps Administrator – Associate

- Validated practical knowledge of cloud operations, monitoring, deployment, and secure infrastructure management in production-style AWS environments.

HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate

- Demonstrated hands-on understanding of infrastructure as code, reusable provisioning patterns, state handling, and automated cloud resource management.

CKA – Certified Kubernetes Administrator

- Confirmed operational knowledge of container orchestration, workload scheduling, networking, troubleshooting, and cluster management for production-ready platforms.